

Severin Rapp

Curriculum Vitae

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Research Interests

Distribution; Public Economics; Welfare, Well-Being, and Poverty; Finance

Research Positions

- 2024–2026 **The Graduate Center at City University New York (CUNY)**, *Stone Center on Socio-Economic Inequality*, New York City, Postdoctoral Scholar
- 2024 **OECD**, *Centre for Wellbeing, Inclusion, Sustainability and Equal Opportunity*, Paris, Economist
- 2024 **Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU)**, *Department of Economics*, Vienna, Teaching and Research Associate

Education

- 2020–2024 **PhD in Economics and Social Sciences**, *Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU)*, Vienna, Thesis: Perspectives on the distribution of wealth: concepts, data and perceptions, Distinction
Supervisors: Prof. Wilfried Altzinger (WU), Prof. Jesus Crespo-Cuaresma (WU), Prof. Max Kasy (Oxford)
- 2018–2019 **MSc in Comparative Social Policy**, *University of Oxford*, Oxford, Distinction
Supervisor: Prof. Brian Nolan
- 2014–2017 **BSc in Economics, Business and Social Sciences**, *Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU)*, Vienna, *GPA 1.16, Ranked among the top 1% of the students in the same cohort*
Economics Track

Visiting Positions and Other Affiliations

- 2024- **Research Associate**, *Research Institute Economics of Inequality (WU INEQ)*, Vienna
- 2023 **Visiting Research Student**, *London School of Economics and Political Science*, London
Advisor: Prof. Francisco Ferreira
- 2016 **Erasmus Exchange**, *University of Edinburgh*, Edinburgh

Journal Publications

- 2025 **S. Rapp.** *Economies of Scale for Household Wealth: An Analysis of Equivalence Scales.* Review of Income and Wealth, 71(1), 176–186,
<https://doi.org/10.1111/roiw.70002>
- 2023 S. Humer and **S. Rapp.** *Wealth and Welfare: Do Private and Public Safety Nets Compensate for Asset Poverty?.* Social Inclusion, 11(1), 176–186,
<https://doi.org/10.17645/si.v11i1.5937>

Research Papers

- JMP **S. Rapp** and F. Disslbacher. *Life Insurance and Wealth: What Shapes Participation and Do Tax Incentives Matter?*
- R&R Scientific Data (Nature) **S. Rapp** and F. Disslbacher. *Wealth Composition, Distribution, and Transmission: The GC Wealth Project Data Warehouse*, joint with M. Longmuir, F. Disslbacher, F. Di Biase, G. Rella, F. Subioli, A. Johnson, M. Targa, S. Morelli, M. Schechtl, T. Asher, L. Giangregorio and I. Flores
- Working Paper F. Disslbacher, M. Haselmayer, L. Lehner, **S. Rapp** and F. Windisch. *The Good Council: Deliberating Inequality in a Field Experiment*. Stone Center on Socio-Economic Inequality Working Paper No. 112 (October 2025)
- Working Paper **S. Rapp** and F. Disslbacher. *Leaving Legacies and Liabilities: The Distribution of Wealth at Death*. World Inequality Lab Working Paper No. 20/2024 (October 2024)
- Under review **S. Rapp** and P. Fessler. *Do Biased Perceptions of Wealth Distribution Affect Savings Behavior?*. Stone Center on Socio-Economic Inequality Working Paper No. 92 (November 2024)

Book Chapters, Research Reports and Other Publications

- 2025 **S. Rapp** and O. Thévenon. *Parenting on a budget: The cost of raising children in changing family configurations and its policy implications*. OECD Papers on Well-being and Inequalities No. 36 (June 2025)
- 2023 **S. Rapp**. *Reichtum, Natur und Wilder Westen: Farrell, Justin (2020). Billionaire Wilderness. The Ultra-Wealthy and the Remaking of the American West*. *Wirtschaft und Gesellschaft*, 49(3), 129–133, <https://doi.org/10.59288/wug493.212>
- 2023 K. Heitzmann and **S. Rapp**. *Armut, soziale Ausgrenzung und Wohnen* [Poverty, social exclusion and housing]. In: A. Buxbaum, U. Filipič, S. Pirklbauer, N. Soukup, N. Wagner (Eds.), *Soziale Lage und Sozialpolitik in Österreich 2023: Entwicklungen und Perspektiven*. ÖGB Verlag
- 2021 **S. Rapp**. *Asset bias in equivalence scale measurement*. WU INEQ Working Paper Series No. 22 (January 2021)
- 2020 C. Dabrowski, R. Lasser, V. Lechinger and **S. Rapp**. *Vermögen in Wien - Ungleichheit und öffentliches Eigentum* [Wealth in Vienna - Inequality and Public Ownership]. Vienna: City of Vienna Municipal Department 23
- 2020 S. Humer and **S. Rapp**. *Kosten von Kindern Erhebungsmethoden und Bandbreiten* [Measuring the Cost of Children: Methods and Bandwidths]. Vienna: City of Vienna Municipal Department 40
- 2018 S. Humer and **S. Rapp**. *Entwicklung und Verteilung von Lebenshaltungskosten* [Development and distributional impact of inflation]. Vienna: Federal Ministry for Work, Social Affairs, Health and Consumer Protection

Awards, Grants and Scholarships

Total monetary value: total: approx. €170,500.00

- 2025 Research grant Kaiserschilf Stiftung
- 2024 Research grant Austrian Chamber of Labour, consultancy project OECD
- 2023 WU International Research Fellow for LSE Visiting Student, research grant City of Vienna Municipality Department No. 23, Klaus Liebscher Economic Research Fellowship Austrian National Bank (OeNB)

- 2022 WU Foundation project grant, WU Scholarship of Teaching and Learning, WU Open Access Publication Fund awarded for Creative Commons publication
- 2021 Eudard März Award for best conference contribution at the 2021 Young Economists Conference in Linz
- 2019 Research grant City of Vienna Municipality Department No. 23, George Smith Award for best MSc-thesis of the University of Oxford's Department of Social Policy and Intervention
- 2018 Maria Szecsi MSc-Scholarship of the Austrian Chamber of Labour
- 2014–2017 WU Rector's List Winter and Summer Term (2x), Academic Achievement Scholarship (3x), Member of the WU Top League

Conference Presentations, Poster Sessions, Invited Talks

- 2025 WU Vienna - Austrian Economic Association Winter Workshop, EEA Annual Congress, ECINEQ Annual Meeting, Lofoten International Forum on Inequality and Taxation, Population Association of America Annual Meeting, III/LIS Comparative Economic Inequality Conference, Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference
- 2024 WU Vienna – LSE-WU-ZEW Workshop on Wealth Inequality, Bocconi – ExPov Poverty and Policy Working Group, OECD ECO – Brownbag Seminar, European Central Bank – HFCN Seminar
- 2023 WU Vienna – Austrian Economic Association Winter Workshop, ESPAnet Annual Conference, ECINEQ Meeting, Renner Institut “Soziale Lage und Sozialpolitik in Österreich”, OeNB Workshop “Measurement of Augmented Wealth”, III/LIS Comparative Economic Inequality Conference, Politecnico Milano – Winter School on Social Insecurity
- 2022 Bocconi – ExPov Working Group, WU Vienna – Workshop on Wealth Inequality and Mobility, Momentum Congress, Austrian Chamber of Labour – Young Economists Conference, SPA Conference, CUNY Stone Center Wealth Seminar Series
- 2021 OeNB HFCN Seminar Series, SPA Annual Conference (online)
- 2020 and prior Austrian Chamber of Labour – Young Economists Conference, ESPAnet Annual Conference, Austrian Economic Association Annual Meeting, ECINEQ Winter School, Momentum Congress, WU Vienna – Austrian Economic Association Winter Workshop

Teaching

- 2022–2024 Supervision of several bachelor theses on wealth inequality and bequests
- 2020–2024 Economic and Fiscal Policy, WU, undergraduate level, focus on social insurance, labour markets, inequality, and COVID-19

Professional Activities

- Reviewer Review of Income and Wealth, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Empirica Journal of European Economics, Italian Economic Journal, Wirtschaft und Gesellschaft, International Journal of Pluralism and Economics Education, OEAD (Austrian Agency for Education and Internationalisation)
- Member European Economic Association, Population Association of America, Society for the Study of Economic Inequality
- Member Institutional Review Board for Research Ethics at WU Vienna, 2021–2023

Representative Student representative for doctoral students, 2021–2023

Member Education Policy Committee and Commissioner for Quality Assurance, Austrian National Union of Students federal body of Representatives (ÖH), 2017–2018

Other Information

Software R, Stan, EViews, STATA, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Markdown, Git

Skills

Languages German (mother tongue), English (C2), French (B2), Spanish (A1)

References

Prof. Janet Gornick

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Prof. Salvatore Morelli

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Prof. Maximilian Kasy

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